{EPITECH}

PORTFOLIO_

< IT'S TIME TO SHOW OFF! />



PORTFOLIO

Use what you've learned to create your own showcase website!

Long associated with the professional art world as a means of highlighting artists' productions, the portfolio is a **personalized and evolving** element.

Etymologically, the term comes from the Latin *portare* and *folium*, meaning *carry* and *leaf*.



According to this Wikipedia article, it ”helps **document education, work samples and skills**. People use career portfolios to **apply for jobs**”.

It is above all a collection of elements **selected according to criteria and organized according to a logic**.



It's much more than just a filing tool, and differs from a resume in that the information it contains is articulated according to a purpose, and **it must present evidence of your accomplishments**.

Goals

Start to build your portfolio, bearing in mind that it must:

- ✓ represent you personally, and therefore be personalized to your image;
- ✓ cover your learning path and be regularly updated;
- ✓ be designed on a digital medium available online *(see below)*;
- ✓ help you present your projects, your progress, and your skills in a **professional way**, to support your future search.



The organization of the portfolio, the choice of productions and the writing of texts involve reflection and often require support.
In other words, you'll need to define your own selection criteria and organizational logic, and you'll probably be asked to justify them in a presentation.

Ideally, your portfolio should be:

- ✓ **synthetic**: to showcase your communication skills;
- ✓ **aesthetic**: to showcase your *front-end* skills;
- ✓ **ergonomic**: to showcase your *UI-UX* skills;
- ✓ **regularly updated**: to showcase your ability to iterate and improve your work over time.

Expectations details

A single portfolio website

You need to build **one single portfolio website**, with your significant productions and experiences.
It is expected to evolve over time, and it must serve multiple objectives:

- ✓ track and showcase your projects and progress across the year;
- ✓ explain what you learned and how you improved;
- ✓ present your skills and your professionalism;
- ✓ highlight relevant experiences outside school projects;
- ✓ help you prepare for your opportunity search.

One website does not mean one page.
Your portfolio **MUST** be made of **several distinct pages**, and the navigation between them must be clear and consistent: from any page, a visitor has to know where they are and how to reach the others.



You can start with your work and then identify the skills you've developed in the process.
Or go the other way round, starting with the skills you want to demonstrate and selecting the projects that best illustrate them.
Or do both simultaneously... it's up to you!

Advice and methodology

Take a few moments to reflect on:

- ✓ your work and skills;
- ✓ your strengths and weaknesses;
- ✓ your challenges and goals;
- ✓ your personal identity;
- ✓ your professional orientation;
- ✓ your learning process and strategies;
- ✓ ...

Gather and sort your work as you would your skills.
Try to classify them according to various criteria (chronology, quality, mastery, etc.).

From your work, select those that demonstrate progress and those that demonstrate mastery.
Look for similarities between projects, and identify the skills you've developed and the progress you've made.

Know how to link a skill to several projects or nuance it according to context.
Understand where you stand and what you need to do to reach your goals.



The presentation of your career path and the prioritization of your content is completely up to you, so it's just as important as your achievements themselves.



By updating it regularly, your latest and best productions will gradually replace your older and less qualitative ones.



Your content is read as much as it is looked at.
Take care of its structure, its clarity and its spelling: a technically flawless website whose texts are poor does not meet the objective.

Your portfolio **MUST contain**, at least:

- ✓ a catchphrase and a (professional) photo;
- ✓ your contact details and a contact form;
- ✓ a reflection on your works (school projects and personal projects), each one making clear:
  - the context and the objective;
  - the skills and technologies involved;
  - the useful links, when they exist (source code, live demo, documentation);
- ✓ a section to present what you learned and how you improved across the year;
- ✓ a section to highlight other experiences outside school projects (Hub, associations, events, etc.);
- ✓ a link to download your CV (preferably in pdf format);
- ✓ resources that are either royalty-free or properly credited (images, themes, fonts, texts).

Your portfolio may:

- ✓ integrate multimedia elements;
- ✓ be open to visitor comments, whose encouragement and formative feedback fuel your motivation;
- ✓ make links between the elements it contains and other online sources;
- ✓ be automatically updated with each new project/repo;
- ✓ include elements related to you and your career, such as:
  - links to professional social networks;
  - an autobiography;
  - a text presenting your professional philosophy;
  - a bibliography of inspirational works;
  - diplomas, certifications and/or honors;
  - challenges encountered and avenues for improvement;

- feedback from professional experience;
- your hobbies and/or interests;
- your involvement with associations;
- ...



The portfolio is proof of your know-how.
Use every means at your disposal to impress the gallery.

Digital

Your portfolio must be produced on a **digital medium accessible online**.

This project is **front-end only**:

✓ no backend is required;
✓ no database is required.

You are free to use any technology you like.
However, your website **MUST** be *Responsive*.

Your website **MUST** also meet basic **accessibility** standards: sufficient color contrast, a text alternative for every meaningful image, a heading structure that follows the content, and every interactive element reachable with the keyboard.

Technical suggestions

Before you start developing, find out about the technical stacks and their benefits, and choose one wisely:

✓ Pre-processors (SASS, LESS, ...), post-processors (postCSS) and generators (iotaCSS);
✓ UI kits (bootstrap, materialize, ...) and micro-frameworks (Skeleton, milligram, ...);
✓ Writing conventions (BEM, ...);
✓ The atomic approach to CSS (TailWindCSS, ...);
✓ CSS libraries in JS (emotion, ...);
✓ Static site generators (Jekyll, Hugo, Astro, ...), which build a multi-page website from content files.



The team recommends at least a post-processor (or a pre-processor), a micro-framework and BEM.

It is **imperative** to:

✓ create a menu to facilitate navigation on your site;
✓ respect good SEO practices for search engines as defined by Google.



Do you know Lighthouse? It audits your SEO and your accessibility, among other things, and tells you what to fix first.

Online

Your portfolio must be hosted online and be accessible to the pedagogical team. We recommend using **GitHub Pages** from the project's repository.

Since your code is already stored in a GitHub repository, GitHub Pages allows you to publish your website online **for free**, directly from this repository.

Publication **MUST** be automated: every modification pushed to your repository has to end up online without any manual step on your side.
Deploying from a branch covers the simplest cases; a GitHub Actions workflow handles those where your website has to be built before being published.

Deliverables

Your repository is part of the delivery, not just a place to store files.

It **MUST contain** every element of your portfolio: the sources of the website, its content, its assets, and the resources you produced or reused.
These elements **MUST** be organized in a readable structure, and documented well enough for someone else to understand where things are, how the website is built and how it is published.



A short `README.md` at the root of your repository, describing the structure and the publication process, is usually enough.

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